

Skills Summary

How to Count On Without Losing a Hop

Use this reference while completing your worksheet or when studying.

Skill 1 — Say the first number, then start hopping

The rule: the number you start from is **free**. It costs no hop.

- Say the first number quietly, then begin counting with the **next** number.
- Take exactly one hop for each thing you are adding. Count the hops on your fingers so you can see them.
- If your answer is one too small, you counted the start number as a hop.

Example: $7 + 2$

Step 1. Hold the first number in your head and remember it is free, so the very first thing you say out loud is already hop one.

Step 2. Seven ... then eight (hop one), nine (hop two)
The total is **9**.

Try it: $5 + 3$

8 :speəp

Skill 2 — Start from the bigger number

The rule: you may add in either order, so start from the **bigger** number and hop the smaller one.

- Fewer hops means fewer chances to lose one.
- The total is the same both ways, so turning the problem around is always allowed.
- Look for the bigger number *before* you start counting, not after.

Example: $2 + 6$

Step 1. The second number is bigger, so turn the problem around first and hop the small one to keep the hop count tiny.

Step 2. Six ... then seven (hop one), eight (hop two)
The total is **8**.

Try it: $3 + 6$

6 :tʃeəp

Skill 3 — Count on to find the missing part

The rule: to find how many **more** you need, count on from what you have up to the total — and the answer is the number of **hops**, not the number of words you say.

- Put up one finger for each hop. At the end, count your fingers.
- Check your answer by adding it back on: the two parts must make the whole.

Example: I have 6. How many more do I need to have 10?

Step 1. Count on from what I have up to the total, and put up a finger for each hop so the hops can be counted instead of the words.

Step 2. Six ... then seven, eight, nine, ten — that is four fingers up
I need **4** more.

Try it: I have 4. How many more do I need to have 7?

⌘ :speəp

(!) **Watch out:** An answer that is exactly one too small almost always means the first number was counted as a hop. Say it quietly, then start hopping on the *next* number.
